

Melody Aleura — Leyline Energy

Conversion Strings

The air around Melody's hands shimmers when she casts. She can draw on a leyline and **convert its energy into acceleration or physical force**. She can also perceive a thread **while another caster is actively using it** and, with considerably more risk, interfere with that pull.

That second ability is not the whole of her affinity. Pushing back against another caster is **one String**; speed and force are other expressions of the same underlying conversion. Melody cannot see the entire dormant leyline network, copy another affinity, or make an enemy's spell perform its opposite effect.

Her first manifestation was **Counterpull**. Her mother was pulling a thread to settle Melody's emotions. Melody instinctively pulled against that active thread, and the uncontrolled tension snapped back on **both** of them. Melody did not cast emotional magic. A trained Counterpull does not automatically reproduce that shared Snapback.

Using this handout

The three parts of every cast

Every String below has a source, a conversion, and an output:

1. **Source:** Melody either draws energy from a leyline herself or engages with a thread another caster is actively pulling.
2. **Conversion:** She directs, spreads, slows, stores briefly, or releases that energy.
3. **Output:** It produces the specific movement, impact, protection, or interference described in the String.

She cannot treat *anything energetic* as a free power source. Being punched does not refill her magic. A past injury does not contain energy she can harvest. Another caster's thread is accessible to her **only while it is being used**, subject to the limits of the particular String.

Table rules

- **PL** is Power Level. Choose a PL Melody can cast; she may deliberately cast at a lower PL.
- **TP** is Tension Points added **when the cast is attempted**, even if the Thread Check fails. **DC** is the Thread Check target. The attribute beside each String is its Thread Check attribute.
- Unless a row says **Reaction**, casting takes a **Major Action**. A Reaction happens at the specified trigger and uses Melody's reaction for that round.
- Melody can concentrate on **one** ongoing String at a time. Its stated range must still be met where specified. Concentration otherwise follows the campaign's normal rules.
- When a String damages an unwilling creature, that creature makes a **RES save against**

that row's DC: success means **half damage and no listed push, Prone, or other rider**. A successful save against a non-damaging forced-movement effect prevents the movement.

- **Opposing an active cast** requires Melody to perceive the active thread and meet the **higher of her row's DC or the opposing cast's DC** on her Thread Check. If the other cast has no stated DC, use its caster's Thread Check result. Failure does not cancel or reverse the other cast; apply THREADCAST's normal failure rules to Melody's attempt.
- Prevented damage cannot exceed damage actually incoming. Unless a row explicitly permits it, preventing damage does **not** also prevent a spell's separate conditions.
- Forced movement needs an open path and an unoccupied destination. These Strings do not move creatures through solid barriers.
- A **pool** is rolled once when created. Track and spend that result; do not reroll it every time it is used.

What Melody can perceive

Without casting a String, Melody can notice **a perceptible active thread** being pulled within **30 ft**. She can see that magic is in use, not necessarily what it will do. Solid barriers and effects that completely hide the casting can prevent this perception. **Calibration** gives her more precise information. It does not charge TP just to notice that someone is casting.

1. The Counterpull String — CTR

Input: A thread another caster is actively pulling.

Conversion: Melody applies an opposing pull and releases the contested tension as safely as she can.

Output: An effect on a threatened creature is weakened or interrupted.

Counterpull works **only as a Reaction** to an active cast Melody can perceive. It is not a general-purpose counterspell against magic that already finished. If a row offers two outcomes, choose one when the cast is attempted.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	When an active cast would affect Melody , contest it. On success, either reduce its damage to her by 1d6 , or suspend one non-damaging magical influence it would impose on her until the start of her

		next turn. Suspending an influence is not ending the caster's ongoing String; it may resume if still maintained afterward.
2	2 / 13	When an active cast would affect Melody or one adjacent creature, contest it. On success, reduce its damage to that one creature by 2d6, or prevent one non-damaging magical influence from taking hold on that creature until the start of Melody's next turn.
3	4 / 15	Contest an active cast affecting one creature within 10 ft. On success, reduce that creature's damage by 3d6. Alternatively, prevent one condition imposed by that cast on that creature; any immediate damage still occurs. Other targets are unaffected.
4	6 / 17	Contest a cast as it is released against one creature within 20 ft. On success, negate that cast's damage and conditions for that one creature. Alternatively, prevent its effect on that creature and vent the excess: Melody, the opposing caster, and every other creature within 5 ft of either of them each take 1d6 bludgeoning

		damage on a failed RES save, or half on a success. A creature within both areas is hit only once. Melody cannot exempt herself or allies from a vent.
5	9 / 19	Contest one cast being released within 30 ft. On success, negate its effects on up to three chosen creatures Melody can see. Alternatively, negate it on one creature and vent contested energy in 10-ft radii around Melody and the opposing caster: creatures in either area, including both casters, take 2d6 bludgeoning damage on a failed RES save, or half on a success. A creature is affected once. The original spell still affects any of its other targets.

Double edge: The vent is a **small physical release**, not the original spell reflected back. A spell meant to slow someone does not turn into a haste spell; Melody has opposed its active pull and released some tension as force. The uncontrolled shared Snapback with her mother was far more dangerous than these practiced effects, and it is **not** something Counterpull guarantees.

2. The Impulse String — POT

Input: Melody's own leyline draw.

Conversion: Concentrate that energy into a brief kinetic pulse through a close strike.

Output: Bludgeoning impact.

Impulse delivers **one** strike per cast. It does not enhance all of Melody's attacks for an entire turn. A target must be within Melody's **melee reach** unless a row says otherwise.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
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1	1 / 11	Deliver one hand, elbow, knee, or held-object strike for 1d6 bludgeoning damage .
2	2 / 13	Strike for 2d6 bludgeoning damage . On a failed RES save, push the target 5 ft directly away from Melody.
3	4 / 15	Strike for 3d6 bludgeoning damage . On a failed RES save, choose to push the target 10 ft or knock it Prone . Choose before the save; it cannot suffer both.
4	6 / 17	Strike one target for 4d8 bludgeoning damage . Alternatively, divide 4d6 damage between up to two targets both within melee reach . The divided strikes have no push or Prone rider.
5	9 / 19	Release the impact through a 15-ft cone for 5d8 bludgeoning damage . Creatures that fail RES saves are pushed 15 ft away from Melody. This is a broad release; she cannot exempt a creature standing inside the cone.

Double edge: Impulse makes her punches hit harder because leyline energy becomes impact. It does not grant superhuman durability to the bones and joints delivering those impacts.

3. The Spring String — POT

Input: Melody's own leyline draw.

Conversion: Turn a brief release into acceleration of **her own body**.

Output: Rapid movement along a traversable route.

Spring is neither teleportation nor flight. Melody needs somewhere to move and a place to land. Additional movement from Spring must be used **during the turn she casts it**.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Gain 10 ft of additional movement this turn. Obstacles and reactions apply normally.
2	2 / 13	Gain 15 ft of additional movement this turn. She can clear one ordinary gap or obstacle up to 5 ft across or high if there is a safe landing space.
3	4 / 15	Move up to 20 ft along an unobstructed route as part of the cast. Choose one creature she can see ; this movement does not trigger that creature's reaction. It may still trigger reactions from others.
4	6 / 17	Move up to 30 ft , then deliver one 2d6 bludgeoning close strike against a creature within reach at the end of that movement. This is one Spring cast, not a free Impulse cast.
5	9 / 19	Move up to 40 ft , changing direction once. She may clear one gap up to 10 ft across with a safe landing.

		During that movement, make one 3d6 bludgeoning strike against a creature she passes within melee reach. Reactions apply except from the creature she strikes.
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Double edge: Conversion supplies speed, not perfect footing or advance knowledge of what is around a corner.

4. The Pressure String — POT

Input: Melody's own leyline draw.

Conversion: Spread kinetic output across a surface or volume of air instead of concentrating it into a punch.

Output: A push or pressure wave.

Pressure cannot affect a creature's organs or blood pressure from inside, and it cannot choose an unseen point inside a body. Its cone begins at Melody.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Push one unattended object weighing no more than 10 lb up to 5 ft within 15 ft . It moves along an open path and cannot deal damage with this use.
2	2 / 13	Send force at one visible creature within 20 ft for 1d6 bludgeoning damage . On a failed RES save, push it 5 ft .
3	4 / 15	Hit one creature within 25 ft for 2d6 bludgeoning damage and push it 10 ft on a failed RES save.

		Alternatively, move one unattended object weighing up to 100 lb by 10 ft along an open path, without dealing damage.
4	6 / 17	Send a wave through a 10-ft cone for 3d6 bludgeoning damage . Creatures that fail RES saves are pushed 10 ft . Loose unattended objects in the cone may also be displaced, but do not become additional attacks.
5	9 / 19	Send a wave through a 15-ft cone for 4d8 bludgeoning damage . Creatures that fail RES saves are pushed 15 ft and knocked Prone . A successful save halves damage and prevents both riders.

Double edge: Pressure gives Melody the “push” and hard-hitting style discussed in the chat, but it is **not** Counterpull. One acts on physical space using her own draw; the other contests another caster’s active thread.

5. The Vector String — CTR

Input: Melody’s own leyline draw.

Conversion: Release force **sideways across the path** of something already moving.

Output: A deflection, not direct control of the moving object.

Melody must see the moving object or traveling projectile. Vector does not give her telekinetic control after the sideways force is applied. It cannot redirect a curse that simply appears on its target, a spell that fills an area at once, or an effect with no traveling path.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
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1	1 / 11	Apply a sideways impulse to one loose, unattended moving object of 5 lb or less within 15 ft , shifting its landing point by up to 5 ft . It cannot be aimed to damage a creature.
2	2 / 13	Reaction to a visible physical projectile aimed at Melody or an adjacent creature. Apply counterforce, reducing that projectile's damage by 2d6 . It lands nearby rather than becoming an attack on a second target.
3	4 / 15	Reaction to a visible physical projectile aimed at a creature within 15 ft . Reduce its damage by 3d6 . If reduced to zero, Melody can send it to an unoccupied point she sees within 15 ft of its original target.
4	6 / 17	Reaction to a visible traveling magical projectile aimed at a creature within 20 ft . Contest its active cast. On success, its trajectory misses that creature and lands at an unoccupied point within 15 ft of the original target. It is still the original magic and may affect something at its landing point.

5	9 / 19	Reaction to one visible projectile or narrow traveling line within 30 ft. Contest an active cast if it is magical. On success, apply enough sideways force to alter its path by up to 30 degrees from the point of intervention. Resolve anything in its new path normally. Melody does not get to choose a guaranteed second victim.
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Double edge: Vector illustrates the physics of her affinity: energy becomes a sideways impulse. The projectile remains real, and she is responsible for where it goes.

6. The Brake String — CTR

Input: Melody's own leyline draw.

Conversion: Apply controlled counterforce **against existing physical momentum.**

Output: A slower impact.

Brake does not erase momentum by decree. The counterforce must have room and time to act, even if only a fraction of a second. It protects against physical strikes, collisions, and falls—not poison, disease, fear, or a spell's separate magical condition.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Reaction when Melody takes physical-impact damage. Apply counterforce and reduce that instance of damage by 1d6 .
2	2 / 13	Reaction when Melody or an adjacent creature takes physical-impact damage. Reduce one creature's damage by 2d6 .

3	4 / 15	Reaction when a creature within 10 ft is struck, collides, or is about to land from a fall. Reduce its impact damage by 3d6 . If this reduces fall damage to zero, it lands safely; it is not protected from a hazard already on the ground.
4	6 / 17	Choose one creature within 15 ft . For 3 rounds while concentrating , reduce the first physical hit against it each round by 2d6 . The protection ends if it leaves Melody's 15-ft range.
5	9 / 19	Reaction to one fall or collision affecting up to three creatures within 20 ft . Roll 6d8 once and divide that amount of impact-damage reduction among them. Unused reduction disappears. This is one intervention against one event.

Double edge: Slowing a falling person does not stop the falling beam behind them. Brake solves the impact it reaches, not every consequence of the accident.

7. The Calibration String — THS

Input: An **active thread** Melody already perceives.

Conversion: Translate fluctuations in that thread's energy into a readable shimmer and physical sense of timing.

Output: Information about **the cast's behavior**, not its caster's thoughts.

Melody does **not** need Calibration to notice someone visibly casting. It refines that innate perception into information she can act on. Unless stated otherwise, the studied thread must remain within **30 ft** and perceptible for the duration of the cast.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 10	Study one active thread . Learn whether its energy is building, sustained, or being released . Melody does not learn the String's name or intended target.
2	2 / 12	Study one active thread. Learn its general direction of release and whether its energy is being applied to one creature, an object, or an area . This does not reveal a target concealed behind a solid barrier.
3	3 / 14	Compare up to two perceptible active threads within 30 ft . Learn which is under greater strain. Gain +1 to one Counterpull or Ground Thread Check against either of those casts before the end of Melody's next turn.
4	5 / 16	Follow one active thread through smoke, a crowd, or similar ordinary visual concealment , but not a solid wall. Recognize its release point and gain +2 to one Counterpull or Ground Thread Check against it before Melody's next turn ends.
5	8 / 18	For 1 minute while concentrating , track up to

		three active threads within 60 ft and distinguish which caster is maintaining each and which release is approaching first. Once during the duration, gain +2 to one Counterpull or Ground check against a tracked cast. A thread that stops being used ceases to be visible to this String.
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Double edge: Calibration can identify the safest instant to intervene—or the instant when an interruption would be most dangerous to everyone nearby.

8. The Ground String — CTR

Input: Energy from an **active damaging magical effect** as it reaches Melody’s vicinity.

Conversion: Divert part of its energetic release into a nearby solid surface using Melody’s own leyline draw to control the route.

Output: Less incoming damage; the energy disperses through the surface instead of becoming an attack.

Ground is a Reaction. Melody must be within **5 ft of a substantial connected surface**—ground, floor, stone wall, or similar—and perceive the active magical release. Contest the opposing cast. Ground does **not** interrupt the caster or remove separate magical conditions. A fragile table, another creature, or empty air is not a safe ground.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Contest an active damaging cast as it affects Melody . On success, reduce its damage to her by 1d6 , venting that amount into a nearby surface. Its other effects still occur.
2	2 / 13	Contest a cast affecting Melody or one adjacent creature . On success,

		reduce its damage to one of them by 2d6 .
3	4 / 15	Contest an active cast that deals damage to a creature within 10 ft . On success, reduce that creature's damage by 3d6 . Melody must still meet Ground's surface requirement.
4	6 / 17	Contest one active cast affecting creatures within 15 ft . On success, roll 4d8 once and divide that total damage reduction among up to two of those creatures. Conditions and damage to others resolve normally.
5	9 / 19	Contest one active cast affecting creatures within 20 ft . On success, roll a 6d8 total reduction pool and divide it among up to three affected creatures. If the surface cannot withstand the vented force, the GM may describe cracking or debris; it does not create free extra damage or cover.

Double edge: Ground is safer than throwing energy back at its caster, but it requires somewhere for that energy to go. It cannot harmlessly erase a spell in midair.

9. The Reserve String — CTR

Input: Part of an **active damaging magical release aimed at Melody**.

Conversion: Reduce the damage reaching her and briefly hold the portion actually diverted.

Output: One later burst of movement, impact, or harmless dissipation.

Reserve is a Reaction when Melody would take magical damage from an active release she perceives. Contest that cast. On success, reduce her damage by the row's dice. Record the **damage actually prevented**, up to that amount, as her *reserve*. She may use it **before the end of her next turn**; otherwise it dissipates. She can hold **only one reserve**. The original spell's conditions still apply unless another effect prevents them.

A later use cannot deal or prevent more points than she actually reserved, even when a row lists larger dice. Taking physical damage, seeing a spell cast at someone else, or watching a non-damaging spell does not supply a reserve.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Reduce magical damage to Melody by 1d6 . She can vent what she captured harmlessly before the end of her next turn; it cannot deal damage.
2	2 / 13	Reduce damage by 2d6 . On her next turn, spend a Major Action to strike a creature within melee reach for up to 1d6 bludgeoning damage , capped by the recorded reserve. The reserve is then spent.
3	4 / 15	Reduce damage by 3d6 . Before the end of her next turn, spend a Major Action either to deal up to 2d6 bludgeoning damage to one creature within 15 ft , or to gain 10 ft of movement that turn. A damaging release is capped by the reserve; either choice expends it.
4	6 / 17	Reduce damage by 4d6 . Before the end of her next turn, spend a Major Action

		to deal up to 3d6 bludgeoning damage to one creature within 20 ft , or use a Reaction to reduce one later hit against Melody by up to 2d6 . Either amount is capped by her recorded reserve and expends it.
5	9 / 19	Reduce damage by 5d8 . Before the end of her next turn, spend a Major Action to deal up to 4d8 bludgeoning damage to one creature within 20 ft , or use a Reaction to reduce one hit against an ally within 10 ft by up to 4d8 . Cap the chosen effect by the reserve and expend it.

Double edge: Reserve is short-lived control of a specific magical release, not an unlimited battery. If Melody cannot safely use what she caught, letting it dissipate is a valid choice.

10. The Shelter String — THS

Input: Melody's own leyline draw.

Conversion: Maintain a controlled outward force around someone she chooses.

Output: Incoming impacts lose some energy before reaching that person.

Shelter reduces **damage from a hit**, whether the hit is physical or a traveling magical impact. It does **not** block a non-impacting enchantment, make someone untargetable, stop poison already in their body, or remove a spell's separate condition.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Place a brief force cushion around one adjacent ally . Reduce the next hit against them by 1d6 damage before Melody's next turn;

		the effect then ends.
2	2 / 13	Protect one ally within 10 ft . Reduce their next incoming hit by 2d6 damage before Melody's next turn.
3	4 / 15	Protect one ally within 15 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Reduce the first damaging hit against them each round by 1d6 . The effect ends if they leave Melody's range.
4	6 / 17	Protect up to two allies within 15 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Roll a 4d8 shared damage-reduction pool on casting. Melody allocates points from it as those allies take hits; spent points are gone.
5	9 / 19	Protect up to three allies within 20 ft for 3 rounds while concentrating . Roll a 6d8 shared reduction pool . Allocate it among incoming hits while the allies remain in range. When the pool is spent, Shelter ends.

Double edge: Shelter needs a sustained draw and Melody's attention. It is protective conversion, not a permanent barrier left behind when she walks away.

11. The Interpose String — THS

Input: An active magical release about to harm an ally, plus Melody's own leyline draw.

Conversion: Melody reroutes part of that active release **through herself**, changing some of it

into a less destructive output before it reaches the ally.

Output: The ally takes less damage; Melody suffers recoil.

Interpose is a Reaction and works only against damage from an **active magical cast Melody can perceive**, not an ordinary punch or a wound that already happened. Contest the opposing cast. On success, reduce the ally's damage by the row's amount. Melody then loses VP equal to **half the damage actually prevented, rounded up**. That VP loss cannot itself be reduced, stored with Reserve, or transferred with another String.

Safety cap: Melody cannot reduce herself below **1 VP** with a controlled Interpose. If necessary, cap the damage she prevents at **twice her current VP minus 2** before calculating recoil. The remainder still hits the ally. This cap represents her trained release; a true uncontrolled Snapback follows the campaign's usual, potentially more dangerous rules.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Protect one adjacent ally from an active magical release, reducing their damage by up to 1d6 and taking the corresponding recoil.
2	4 / 15	Protect one ally within 10 ft , reducing their damage by up to 2d6 and taking recoil.
3	6 / 17	Protect one ally within 15 ft , reducing their damage by up to 3d6 and taking recoil.
4	8 / 19	Protect one ally within 20 ft , reducing their damage by up to 4d8 and taking recoil. If the attacking caster is within 20 ft of Melody , she may vent part of the remaining converted energy as 1d6 bludgeoning damage to that caster; this

		does not refund her VP.
5	11 / 21	Protect up to two allies within 20 ft from the same active magical release . Divide a 6d8 total damage-reduction pool between them. Melody takes recoil equal to half the total damage actually prevented , rounded up. This is one Reaction against one cast, not protection from every attack that round.

Double edge: Interpose is useful and costly, especially when Lemon is in danger. It is **not** evidence that love requires Melody to suffer. Her parents' religious claims about pain and obedience are their coercive beliefs, not a truth imposed by the affinity.

12. The Circuit String — CTR

Input: Melody's own leyline draw.

Conversion: Divide one controlled flow among **specific, simultaneous outputs**.

Output: Coordinated movement, impact, or protection.

Circuit does not grant free casts of Melody's other Strings. Every row below is a **single Circuit cast** with only the effects stated there. At PL 4–5, roll the pool once. She may spend from it **at most once per round**; an unspent pool disappears when concentration or the stated duration ends.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Apply two small physical pushes at once: move two unattended objects , each weighing no more than 5 lb , up to 5 ft each within 15 ft . Neither movement deals damage.

2	4 / 15	Convert one draw into two sequential outputs during the cast: move up to 10 ft along a traversable route and deliver one 1d6 bludgeoning close strike at any point during that movement. This uses one Major Action.
3	6 / 17	Divide 3d6 bludgeoning damage among up to two creatures within 15 ft. Alternatively, replace one die of that damage with a controlled push moving one willing ally within 15 ft up to 5 ft to an unoccupied space. Choose the allocation before saves.
4	8 / 19	For 3 rounds while concentrating , roll a 4d8 conversion pool . Melody may spend from it once as part of this cast and once on each later round: spend a Major Action to deal a chosen number of its remaining points as bludgeoning damage to one creature within 20 ft , or use a Reaction to reduce one hit against an ally within 20 ft by that many points. Points are spent once, not both ways.
5	11 / 21	For 3 rounds while concentrating , roll a 7d8 conversion pool . Spend from it once as part of this

		cast and at most once per later round. A Major Action deals chosen remaining points as bludgeoning damage to one creature within 30 ft; a Reaction reduces one hit against an ally within 30 ft; or a Major Action spends 8 points to move one willing ally within 30 ft up to 10 ft along a safe, open path. A single damage or protection use cannot spend more than half the original pool, rounded up.
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Double edge: Circuit is not limitless power. It is Melody maintaining precise control while deciding where a finite draw should go.